Enrollment & attendance

Northstar Learning Institute | Fictional demonstration handbook | 2026 edition.

The Applied AI certificate lasts 12 weeks. Teaching begins on 3 August 2026. Classes meet on Mondays and Wednesdays from 6:00 PM to 8:00 PM.

Students must attend at least 80 percent of scheduled classes to qualify for the certificate. Absences should be reported to the program coordinator by email before the session.

Enrollment closes on 24 July 2026. Applicants must complete the Python foundations module before enrollment. The cohort is limited to 30 students.

Assessment & extensions

Assessment consists of weekly assignments worth 40 percent, a capstone project worth 50 percent, and participation worth 10 percent of the final grade.

Students need a final grade of at least 60 percent to pass. Weekly assignments are due every Sunday at 11:59 PM in the institute's local time.

A late assignment loses 5 percentage points per day and is not accepted after 3 days. An extension must be requested at least 48 hours before the deadline. Approved medical absences are exempt from the late penalty.

Capstone & academic integrity

The capstone submission deadline is 23 October 2026 at 5:00 PM. Teams may contain between one and three students.

Every capstone submission must include a source-code repository, a README with setup instructions, an evaluation report, and a demonstration video no longer than 5 minutes.

Students may use AI tools but must disclose their use in the README. All external datasets and code must be attributed. Fabricated evaluation results are prohibited.

The final presentation is 10 minutes long, followed by 5 minutes of questions. Projects are assessed on correctness, evidence quality, usability, and the team's explanation of limitations.